

Voluntary Report – Voluntary - Public Distribution

Date: September 11,2020

Report Number: IN2020-0121

Report Name: FSSAI Proposes Draft Standards for Walnut Kernels and Other Various Food Products

Country: India

Post: New Delhi

Report Category: Sanitary/Phytosanitary/Food Safety, Exporter Guide, Grain and Feed, FAIRS Subject Report, Tree Nuts, Dairy and Products, Beverages, Oilseeds and Products, Food Processing Ingredients, Coffee

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Report Highlights:

India notified draft amendments to the World Trade Organization (WTO) on new walnut kernel standards and a range of food products including dairy and dairy products, oilseeds and products, margarine and fat spreads, besan (ground dehusked garbanzo beans), and cereal and cereal products, among others. WTO trading partners are invited to comment on these draft amendments and the comment period expires 60 days beyond the notification date listed on the WTO website.

General Information:

DISCLAIMER: The information contained in this report was retrieved from the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India's (FSSAI) website <http://www.fssai.gov.in/>. The Office of Agricultural Affairs, USDA and/or the U.S. Government make no claim of accuracy or authenticity.

On September 3, 2020, the Government of India's (GOI's) Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) amended the Food Safety and Standards (Food Products Standards and Food Additives) Regulations, 2011, and invited WTO member countries to offer their comments on the amendments. Major amendments relate to new standards for certain food products and modified standards for others. The affected products include walnut kernels, buffalo milk, oils (includes peanut, flaxseed, rapeseed, poppy seed, safflower seed, taramira, sesame, niger seed, soybean, maize, watermelon seed, sunflower seed, avocado, grapeseed, interesterified and hydrogenated vegetables), margarine and fat spreads, soybean sauce, *besan* (ground dehusked Bengal gram), maize starch, oat products, soy dahi/yogurt, yellow pea powder, black, white and green peppers, dried sage, instant tea in solid form, caffeinated and non-alcoholic beverages, packaged drinking water, sweeteners and chewing gum.

Some observations on the notification are provided below. Readers should carefully note the full notification text for a better understanding of the new and modified standards proposed by FSSAI.

- The walnut kernel standards are for fresh product.
- Buffalo milk minimum milk fat percent reduced by one percent from its earlier standard of six percent (in select 14 states/Union Territory: Assam, Bihar, Chandigarh, Delhi, Gujarat, Haryana, Jharkhand, Maharashtra, Meghalaya, Punjab, Sikkim, Uttar Pradesh, Uttarakhand, and West Bengal), whereas solids-not-fat percent remains unchanged at nine percent.
- Other than oat products in breakfast cereals, etc., India does not import U.S. products derived from corn, oat, peas and Bengal gram (garbanzo beans).

The PDF version of FSSAI's proposed amendments is attached to this report and is available on FSSAI's website at:

https://www.fssai.gov.in/upload/uploadfiles/files/Draft_WTO_SPS_Notification_Walnuts_03_09_2020.pdf

Attachments:

[200903-FSSAI Notification Walnut Kernels Varied Food Products.docx](#)